

VICTORIA VO – DES 157B CAPSTONE

ATTENTION ECONOMY

● Sleep & Rest

● Classes & School

● Study & Homework

● Work

● Social & Friends

● Exercise & Health

● Meals & Cooking

Screen time

OVERVIEW

What is the “Attention Economy”?

It is a system where human attention is treated as a **scarce commodity** and **monetized** by digital platforms and advertisers.



Today, many popular social media platforms such as Instagram, Facebook, and TikTok are “free” to use, but operate in exchange for our attention and data, which is sold to advertisers.

OVERVIEW

Project Goals

Through this project, I want to reflect on something that is already relevant today, but will likely continue to become increasingly present in our lives in the future, asking what if the attention economy continues to evolve unchecked.

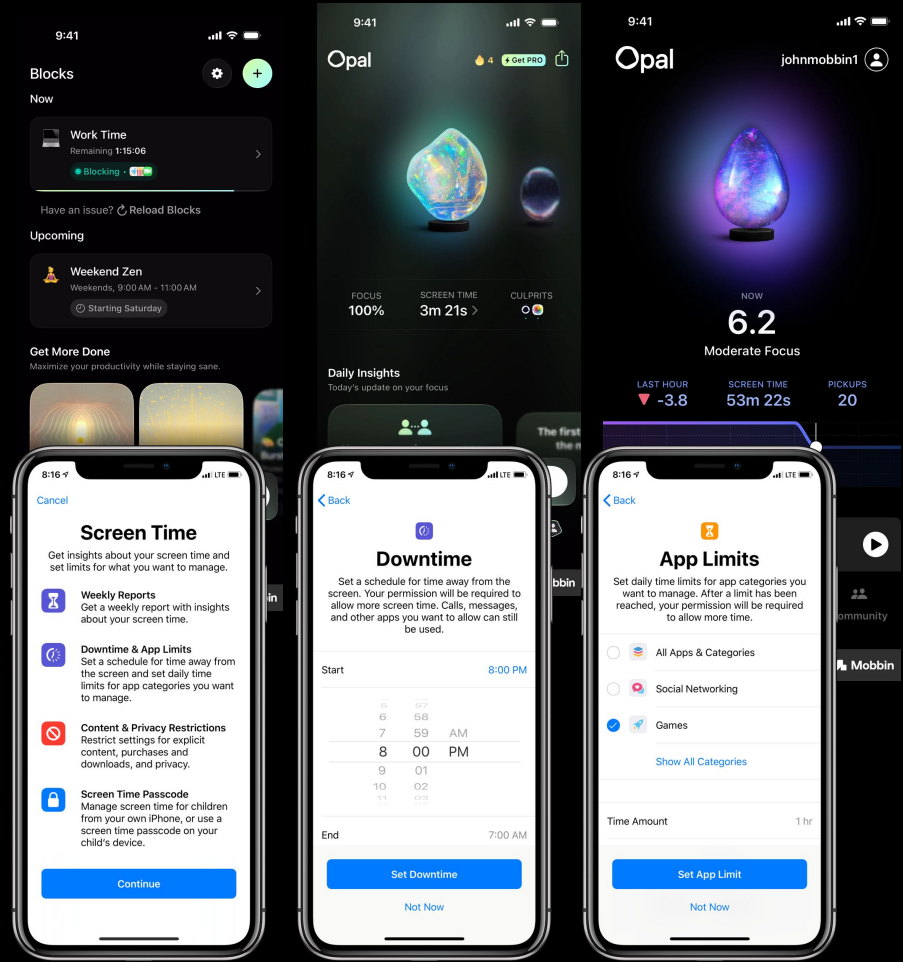
What if the very act of thinking, feeling, and choosing becomes a resource to be harvested?

Comparative Analysis

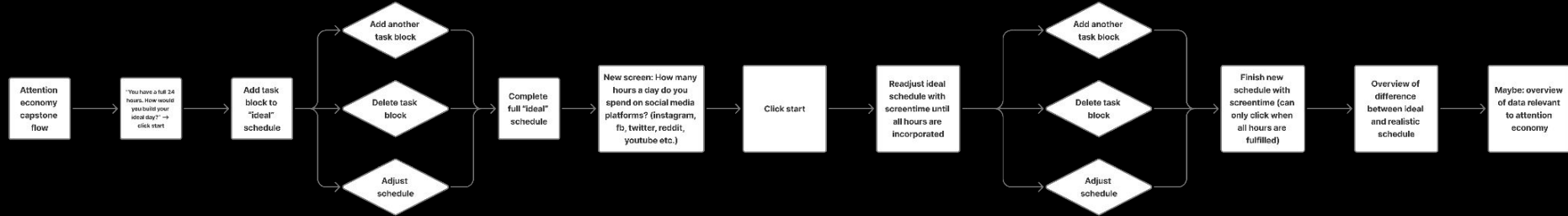
I examined two existing popular tools for screentime management: Opal & the default built-in iOS feature for Apple devices.

Main patterns noticed:

- Elaborate use of color for data
- Visualizations (bars and graphs) for screentime
- Strong informational hierarchy



PROCESS – USER FLOW



At this stage, I determined what features i wanted to implement and how the user would navigate through the webpage with the main function being a **24 hour schedule builder**

PROCESS – WIREFRAMES

Early Wireframes on Figma

The average American spends about **7 hours** daily looking at a screen.

Can you fit it into your day?

GET STARTED

YOUR DAY

0/24 HOURS CLEAR



SLEEP

COOK

WORK

SCROLL

SOCIAL

DATE

COMMUTING

OVERVIEW

Today you slept for **6 hours**. – Not bad

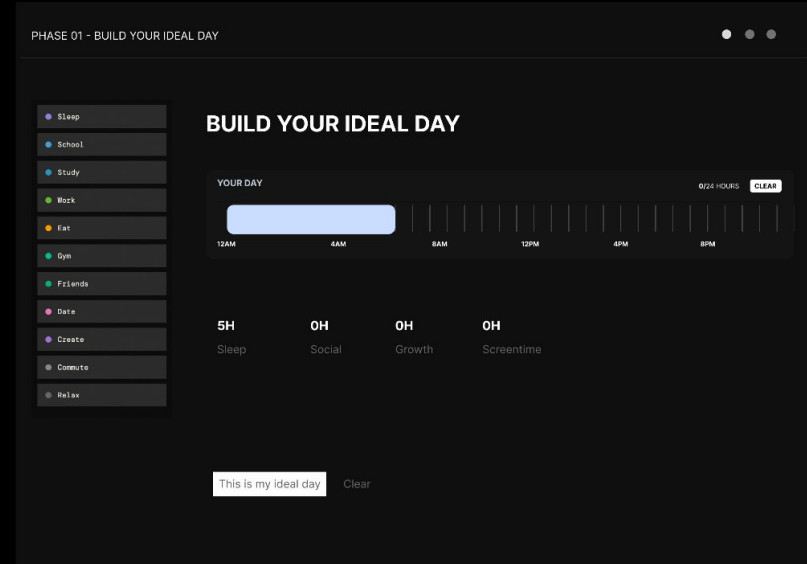
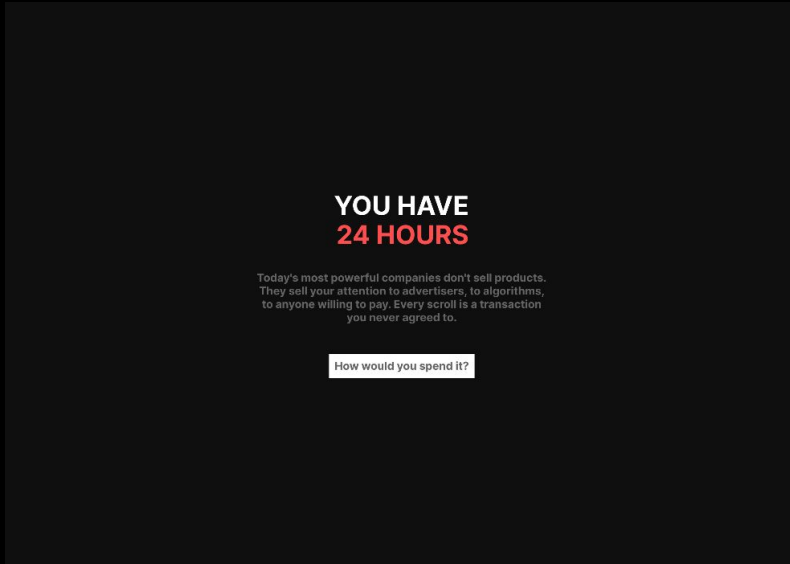
You spent 0 hours cooking and 0 hours cleaning. – How are you alive?

You spent 0 hours hanging out with friends and 0 hours dating. – Aren't you lonely?

You spent 0 hours working – How are you funding this?

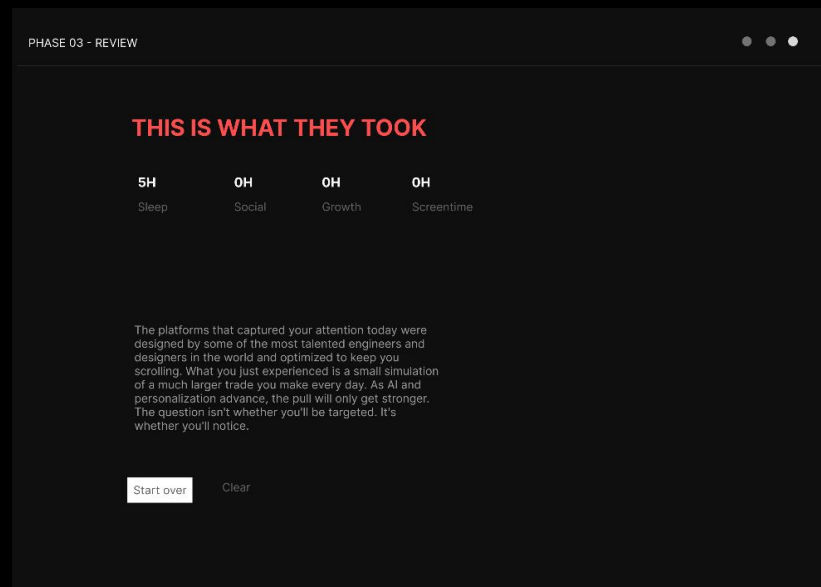
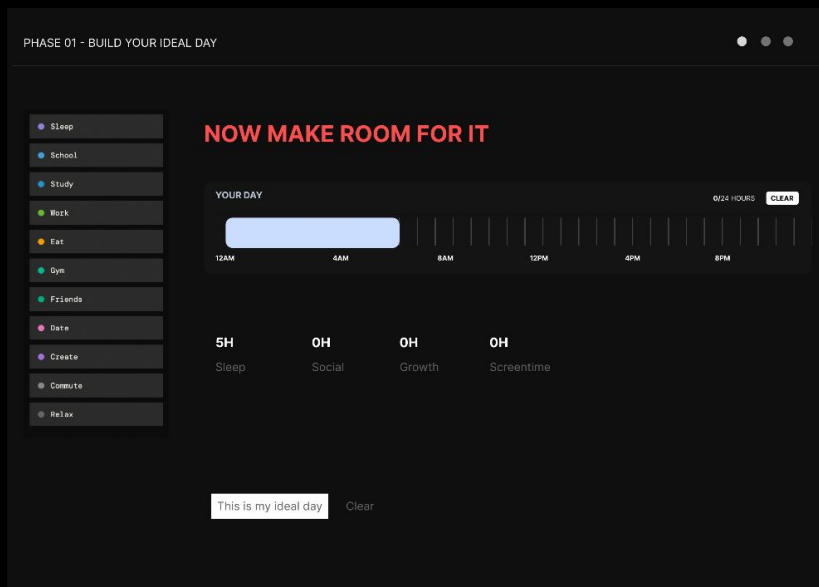
PROCESS – WIREFRAMES

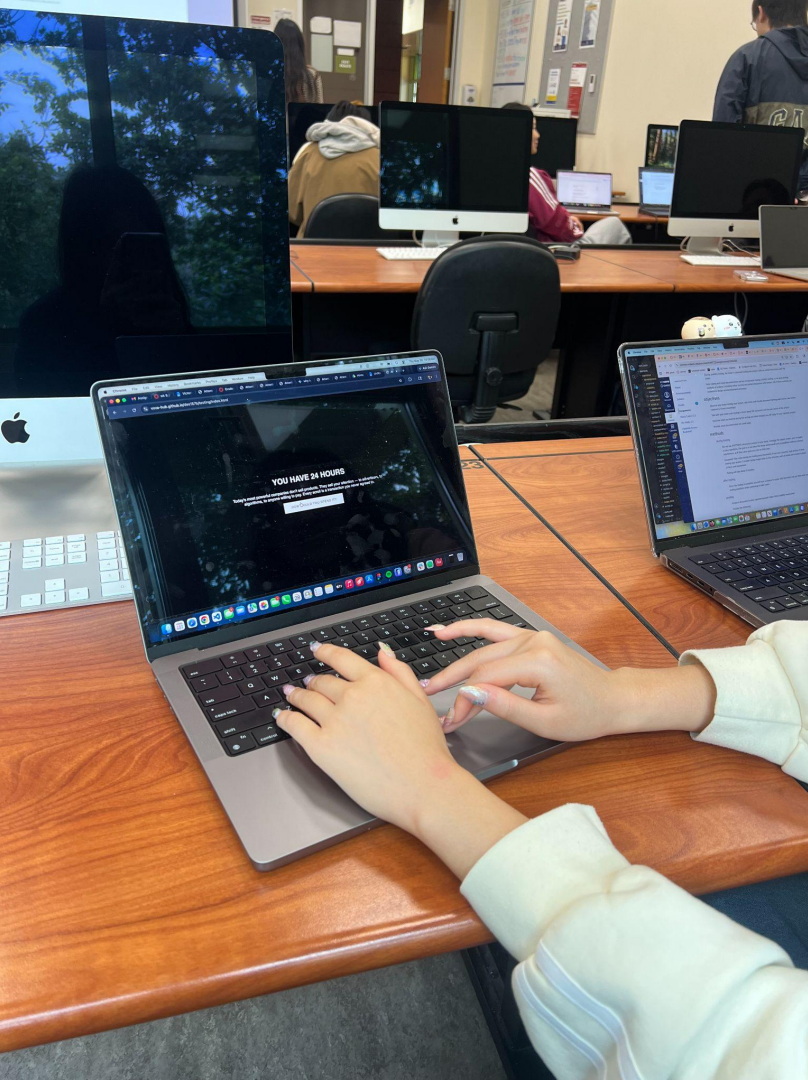
Further Development



PROCESS – WIREFRAMES

Further Development cont.





PROCESS - USABILITY TESTING

Getting Feedback

Through sharing interactive prototypes with my classmates, and checking in with the teaching team, I gained some insightful feedback on things to consider and change.

- Needed to more clearly define and show my intended impact → Creating a reflective comparison page + calculating long term impact of daily screen usage over 10 years
- Adding more personalization → Added option for user input on their personal screentime instead of originally using the average
- Exploring typography (was only using basic "Inter" font for everything) → used more stylized fonts to add character

PROCESS – DEVELOPMENT

Using Plug-Ins

Initially, I intended to use Shopify's plug-in for their sortable components, but realized the JQuery UI library was a better option for my schedule building tool,

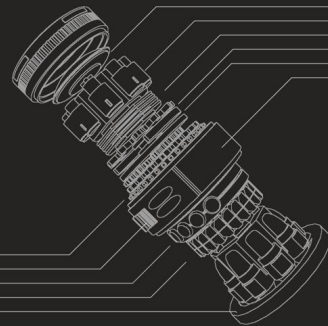
I also used [Anime.js](#) for smooth transitions when presenting the comparison/reflection page.



jQuery
user interface
Tutorial

anime.js

**JavaScript
Animation
Engine**



PROCESS – DEVELOPMENT

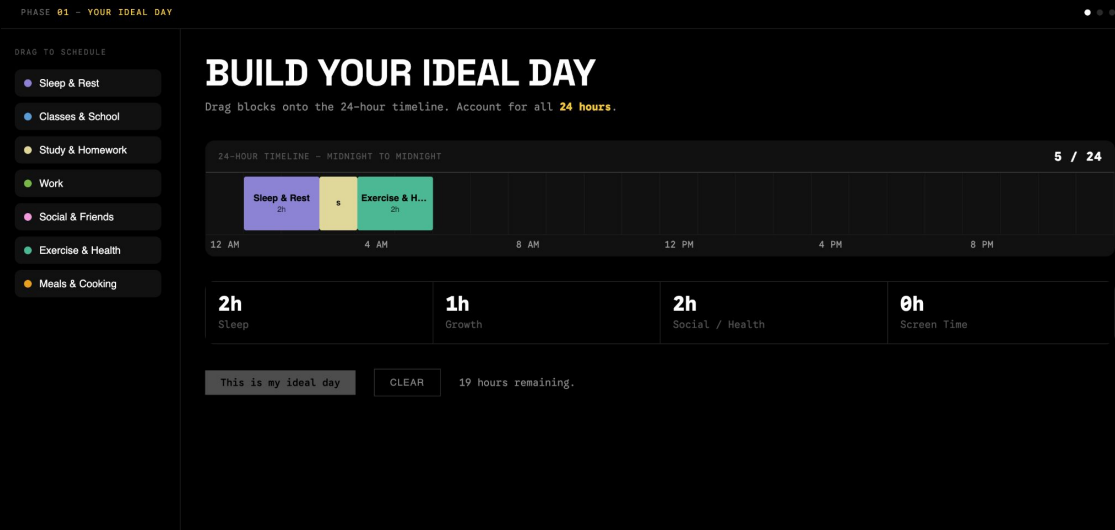
Final Project

<https://vxvo-hub.github.io/des157b/capstone/index.html>

YOU HAVE 24 HOURS

Today's most powerful companies don't sell products. They sell **your attention** to advertisers, to algorithms, to anyone willing to pay. Every scroll is a transaction for your attention.

How would you spend it?



SUMMARY

Challenges

- Learning how to use plug-ins, reading through documentation
- Working with a complex feature and data
- Limited usability testing before final development (did not have functioning versions previously)
 - Realized usability issues after final development

Accomplishments

- Learned more about a relevant issue to the present and future of social media, how it is monetized through exploiting our time and attention
- Learned more about impact of social media on our attention span
- Established strong visual design for interface with color and typography